

Chapter 3

Object Orientation

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Objectives

- At the end of this chapter students should be able to:
 - Understand **inheritance** and how to use it to develop new classes based on existing classes.
 - Learn the notions of **superclasses** and **subclasses** and the relationship between them.
 - Use keyword **extends** to create a class that inherits attributes and behaviors from another class.
 - Hide member data of superclass -- **encapsulation**
 - Access superclass members with **super** keyword from a subclass.
 - Learn how **constructors** are used in inheritance hierarchies.
 - Discover **polymorphism** and **dynamic binding**.
 - Learn how **polymorphism** makes systems **extensible** and **maintainable**.

Objectives...

- Describe **casting** and explain why **explicit downcasting** is necessary.
- Use **final** classes and methods.
- Use **overridden methods** to effect polymorphism.
- Distinguish differences between **method overriding** and **method overloading**.
- Design and use **abstract classes** and **abstract methods**.
- Declare and implement **interfaces** and define classes that implement interfaces.
- Explore the similarities and differences among **concrete classes**, **abstract classes**, and **interfaces**.
- Learn about the methods of class **Object**, the direct or indirect superclass of all classes.

Inheritance

- A form of **software reuse** in which a new class is created by reusing an existing class's members and embellishing them with new or modified capabilities.
- The Java class hierarchy begins with class **Object** (in package **java.lang**):
 - *Every class in Java directly or indirectly extends (or “inherits from”) Object.*
- Inheritance represents **is-a** relationship.
- Is-a represents **inheritance** where an object of a subclass can also be treated as an object of its superclass.

Example: Studnet is a Person.

Superclasses and Subclasses

- Superclasses tend to be “more general” and subclasses “more specific.”
- Because every subclass object is an object of its superclass, and one superclass can have many subclasses, the set of objects represented by a superclass is typically larger than the set of objects represented by any of its subclasses.

Inheritance examples:

Superclass	Subclasses
Student	GraduateStudent, UndergraduateStudent
Shape	Circle, Triangle, Rectangle, Sphere, Cube
Employee	Faculty, Staff

CommunityMember Inheritance Hierarchy

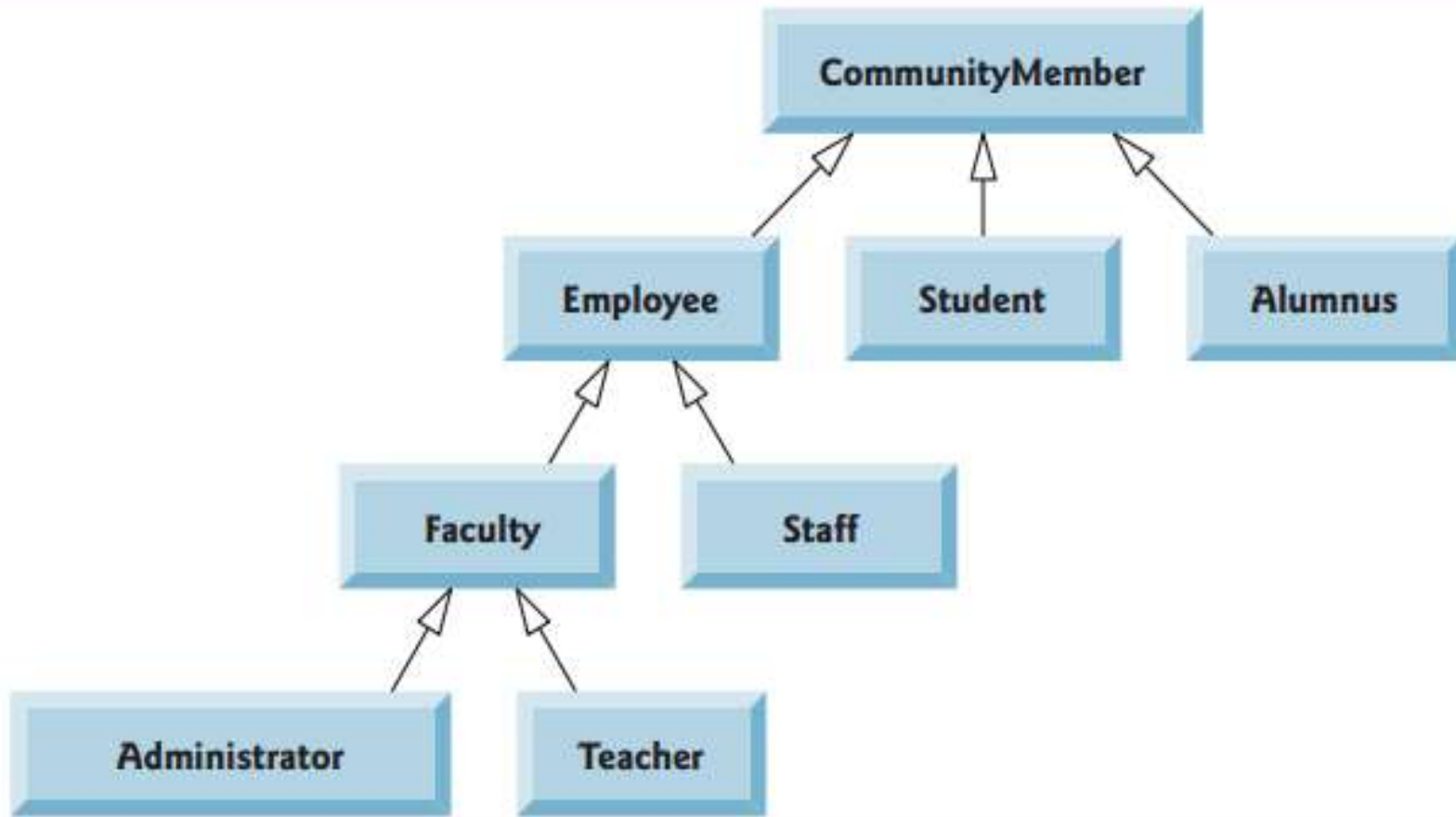


Fig. Inheritance hierarchy UML class diagram for university **CommunityMembers**

Defining a Subclass

- A subclass inherits members from a superclass.
- You can also:
 - ☞ Add new properties
 - ☞ Add new methods
 - ☞ Override / redefine the methods of the superclass with an appropriate implementation.
- Java syntax for indicating inheritance / defining subclass:

```
class SubClass extends SuperClass {  
    }  
}
```

- **extends** keyword is used to define subclass

Using the Keyword `super`

- The keyword `super` refers to the superclass of the class in which `super` appears.
- Super keyword can be used in two ways:
 - To call a superclass constructor
 - To call a superclass method
- Invoking a superclass constructor's name in a subclass causes a **syntax error**.
- You must use the keyword `super` to call the superclass constructor from the subclass.

Calling Superclass Constructors

- Constructors are not inherited.
- The first task of any subclass constructor is to call its direct superclass's constructor, either explicitly or implicitly.
- Superclass's constructor is always invoked.
- The syntax to call a superclass's constructor is :

`super()`, or

`super(parameters);` *// explicit call*
- A class's default constructor (when generated by the compiler) calls the superclass's default or no-argument constructor.

Calling Superclass Constructors...

- A constructor may invoke an overloaded constructor or its superclass constructor.
- If neither is invoked explicitly, the compiler automatically puts `super()` as the first statement in the constructor.

```
public ClassName() {  
    // some statements  
}
```

Equivalent

```
public ClassName() {  
    super();  
    // some statements  
}
```

```
public ClassName(double d) {  
    // some statements  
}
```

Equivalent

```
public ClassName(double d) {  
    super();  
    // some statements  
}
```

Calling Superclass Constructors...

- Syntax error occurs if the superclass does not have a no-arg constructor and the subclass tries to invoke this constructor.

Consider the following code:

```
class Fruit {  
    public Fruit(String name) {  
        System.out.println("Fruit's constructor is invoked");  
    }  
}
```

```
public class Apple extends Fruit {  
}
```

What is the error in this program?

Constructor Chaining

- Constructing an instance of a class invokes all the superclasses' constructors along the inheritance chain.
- This is known as ***constructor chaining***.

Example of constructor chaining

```
public class Faculty extends Employee {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        new Faculty();  
    }  
    public Faculty() {  
        System.out.println("(4) Faculty's no-arg constructor is invoked");  
    }  
}
```

```
class Employee extends Person {  
    public Employee() {  
        this("(2) Invoke Employee's overloaded constructor");  
        System.out.println("(3) Employee's no-arg constructor is invoked");  
    }  
    public Employee(String s) {  
        System.out.println(s);  
    }  
}
```

```
class Person {  
    public Person() {  
        System.out.println("(1) Person's no-arg constructor is invoked");  
    }  
}
```

Using Super to call superclass method

➤ The syntax is:

super.method(parameters);

Example:

```
1 package chapter3;
2
3 public class Parent {
4     void display(){
5         System.out.println("Parent Display");
6     }
7 }
8
9 }
```

```
1 package chapter3;
2
3 public class Child extends Parent {
4
5     @Override
6     void display(){
7         System.out.println("Child Display");
8         super.display();
9     }
10 }
11
12 class Test{
13     public static void main(String[] args) {
14         Child c = new Child();
15         c.display();
16     }
17 }
18
19 }
```

Output???

Child Display

Parent Display

Using Super to call superclass method

- Note: it is not always necessary to use the keyword super to call superclass method when:
 - Method is not overridden
 - To call child class overridden method, without super java calls child's overridden method
- Java don't allow to use super keyword inside a static method because super refers to parent class object.
- It is acceptable to call a static method from a constructor.
- But java don't allow overridable methods to be called from constructors

Overriding Methods

- Modifying the implementation of an inherited method defined in the superclass is referred to as method overriding.
- To override a method, the method must be defined in the subclass using the same signature and the same return type as in its superclass.
- **@Override** annotation:
 - Indicates that a method should override a superclass method with the same signature.
 - If it does not, a compilation error occurs in earlier JDK versions.

Overriding Methods...

Example:

```
@Override  
public String toString()  
{  
    // specific implementation  
}
```

- It's a compilation error to override a method with a *more restricted access such as private, final, etc.*

Overriding Methods...

- A private method cannot be overridden.
- A static method can be inherited, but cannot be overridden.
- If a static method defined in the superclass is redefined in a subclass, the method defined in the superclass is hidden.
- The hidden static methods can be invoked using the syntax:

SuperClassName.staticMethodName

Overriding vs. Overloading

```
public class Test{

    public static void main(String[] args){

        A a = new A();

        a.pow(10);

        a.pow(10.0);

    }

}

class B {

    public void p(double i){

        System.out.println(i * 2);

    }

}

class A extends B

// This method overrides the method in B

    public void p(double i){

        System.out.println(i);

    }

}
```

```
public class Test{

    public static void main(String[] args){

        A a = new A();

        a.pow(10);

        a.pow(10.0);

    }

}

class B {

    public void p(double i){

        System.out.println(i * 2);

    }

}

class A extends B

// This method overloads the method in B

    public void p(int i){

        System.out.println(i);

    }

}
```

Implementing Inheritance

- *At the design stage in an object-oriented system, you'll often find that certain classes are closely related.*
- *You should “factor out” common instance variables and methods and place them in a superclass.*
- *Then use inheritance to develop subclasses, specializing them with capabilities beyond those inherited from the superclass.*
- *Changes made to the common features in the superclass are inherited by the subclass.*

Class Object

- All classes in Java inherit directly or indirectly from **java.lang.Object** class, so its methods are inherited by all other classes.
- Commonly used Object methods are:
 - `toString()`
 - `equals()`
 - `getClass()`
- Learn more about Object's methods in the online API documentation.

The `toString()` method in `Object`

- The `toString()` method returns a string representation of the object.
- The default implementation returns a string consisting of a class name of which the object is an instance, the at sign (`@`), and a number(hash code) representing this object.

Example:

```
Loan loan = new Loan();  
System.out.println(loan.toString());
```

- The code displays something like **Loan@15037e5**.
- This message is not very helpful or informative.
- Usually you should override the `toString` method

The equals Method

- The **equals()** method compares the contents of two objects (whether two objects are equal).
- The default implementation of the equals method in the Object class is as follows:

```
public boolean equals(Object obj) {  
    return (this == obj);  
}
```

- The syntax for invoking **equals()** method is:
object1.equals(object2);

`==` vs `equals()`

- The `==` comparison operator is used for comparing two primitive data type values or for determining whether two objects have the same references.
- The `equals` method is intended to test whether two objects have the same contents
- The `==` operator is stronger than the `equals` method, in that the `==` operator checks whether the two reference variables refer to the same object.

Polymorphism

- In polymorphism a variable of a supertype can refer to a subtype object.
- Polymorphism allows to use a single variable as reference to instances of multiple subclasses of the same superclass.
- A class defines a type.
 - A type defined by a subclass is called a subtype, and a type defined by its superclass is called a supertype.

Example: **Student** s = new **PostgradStudent**();

Therefore, you can say that **postgradStudent** is a subtype of **Student** and **Student** is a supertype for **postgradStudent**.

Polymorphism...

- The same method name and signature can cause different actions to occur, depending on the type of object on which the method is invoked.
- When a superclass variable contains a reference to a subclass object, and that reference is used to call a method, the subclass version of the method is called.

Demo

- An object of a subclass is an object of its superclass type (but not vice versa).

Dynamic Binding

- Connecting a method call to the method body is known as binding.
- When the compiler encounters a method call made through a variable, the compiler determines if the method can be called by checking the variable's class type.
 - If that class contains the proper method declaration (or inherits one), the call is compiled.
- At execution time, JVM checks the type of the object to which the variable refers to determine the actual method to use.
 - This process is called **dynamic (run time, late) binding**.

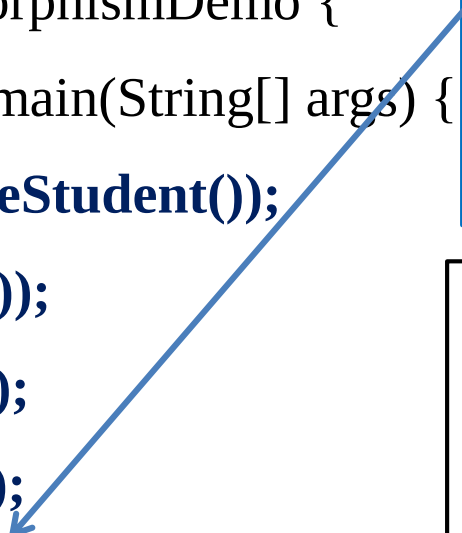
Example

```
class Person extends Object {  
    public String toString() {  
        return "Person";  
    }  
}
```

```
class GraduateStudent extends Student {  
}  
  
class Student extends Person {  
    public String toString() {  
        return "Student";  
    }  
}
```

Example...

```
public class PolymorphismDemo {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        m(new GraduateStudent());  
        m(new Student());  
        m(new Person());  
        m(new Object());  
    }  
  
    public static void m(Object x) {  
        System.out.println(x.toString() );  
    }  
}
```



Method **m** takes a parameter of the Object type.

You can invoke it with any object.(polymorphic call)

- When the method `m(Object x)` is executed, the argument `x`'s `toString` method is invoked.
- `x` may be an instance of `GraduateStudent`, `Student`, `Person`, or `Object`.
- Classes `GraduateStudent`, `Student`, `Person`, and `Object` have their own implementation of the `toString` method.
- Which implementation is used will be determined dynamically by the Java Virtual Machine at runtime -- **dynamic binding**.

Generic Programming

- Polymorphism allows methods to be used generically for a wide range of object arguments. This is known as generic programming.
- If a method's parameter type is a superclass (e.g., Object), you may pass an object to this method of any of the parameter's subclasses (e.g., Student or String).
- When an object (e.g., a Student object or a String object) is used in the method, the particular implementation of the method of the object that is invoked (e.g., toString) is determined dynamically.

Method Matching vs. Binding

- Matching a method signature and binding a method implementation are two issues.
- The compiler finds a matching method according to parameter type, number of parameters, and order of the parameters at compilation time.
- A method may be implemented in several subclasses.
- The Java Virtual Machine dynamically binds the implementation of the method at runtime.

Casting Objects

➤ *Casting* can be used to convert an object of one class type to another within an inheritance hierarchy.

➤ In the preceding section, the statement:

```
m(new Student());
```

assigns the object `new Student()` to a parameter of the `Object` type. This statement is equivalent to:

```
Object o = new Student(); // Implicit casting
```

```
m(o);
```



The statement `Object o = new Student()`, known as implicit casting, is legal because an instance of `Student` is automatically an instance of `Object`.

Why Casting Is Necessary?

➤ Suppose you want to assign the object reference **o** to a variable of the Student type using the following statement:

```
Object o = new Student();
```

```
Student b = o; // A compile error would occur
```

➤ *Why does the statement **Object o = new Student()** work and the statement **Student b = o** doesn't?*

➤ This is because a Student object is always an instance of Object, but an Object is not necessarily an instance of Student.

➤ Even though you can see that **o** is really a Student object, the compiler is not so clever to know it.

➤ To tell the compiler that **o** is a Student object, use an explicit casting. The syntax is:

```
Student b = (Student)o; // Explicit casting -- downcasting
```

instanceof Operator and Downcasting

- Explicit casting must be used when casting an object from a superclass to a subclass.
- This type of casting may not always succeed.
- Attempting to assign a superclass reference to a subclass variable is a compilation error.
 - To avoid this error, the superclass reference must be casted (downcasting reference) to a subclass type explicitly.
- At execution time, if the object to which the reference refers is not a subclass object, a ***ClassCastException*** exception will occur.
 - Use the ***instanceof*** operator to ensure that such a cast is performed only if the object is a subclass object.

DEMO - Typecasting.java

Abstract Classes and Methods

➤ Abstract classes:

- Cannot be used to instantiate objects—abstract classes are too general and *incomplete*.
- Subclasses must declare the “missing pieces” to become “**concrete**” classes, from which you can instantiate objects; otherwise, these subclasses, too, will be abstract.
- An abstract class declares common attributes and behaviors (both abstract and concrete) of the various classes in a class hierarchy.
- enables these classes to inherit those attributes and behaviors and share a common design.

Abstract Classes and Methods...

- An abstract class must contain at least one *abstract method*.
- Abstract methods do not provide implementations (method bodies).
- Each concrete subclass of an *abstract* superclass must provide concrete implementations of each of the superclass's abstract methods otherwise the subclass is also declared abstract.

➤ **Constructors, *private*, *final*, and *static* methods cannot be declared *abstract*. Why?**

final Methods and Classes

- A *final method* cannot be overridden in a subclass.
 - *Private* and *static* methods are implicitly *final*.
 - Calls to *final* methods are always resolved at compile time - this is known as *static (compiler time, early) binding*.
- A final class cannot be extended to create a subclass.
- All methods in a *final* class are implicitly *final*.
- A final data field is a constant.

Example: `final static double PI = 3.14159;`

Creating and Using Interfaces

- An interface is a class like construct that contains only constants and abstract methods.
- An interface is used to specify common behaviors (methods and constants) for objects.
- An interface is often used when disparate (unrelated) classes need to share common methods and constants.
- Allows objects of unrelated classes to be processed polymorphically by responding to the same method calls.
- You cannot create an instance from an interface using the new operator.
- Interfaces may not specify any implementation details, such as concrete method declarations and instance variables.

Creating and Using Interfaces...

- Syntax to define an interface:

```
public interface InterfaceName {
```

```
    //constant declarations and abstract method signatures
```

```
}
```

- All methods declared in an interface are implicitly *public abstract* methods.
- All data fields are implicitly *public, static, and final*.

For example:

```
public interface T1{  
    public static final int K = 1;  
    public abstract void p();  
}
```

Equivalent

```
public interface T1{  
    int K = 1;  
    void p();  
}
```

Creating and Using Interfaces...

- A constant defined in an interface can be accessed using syntax:

InterfaceName.CONSTANT_NAME ;

Example: T1.K

- To use an interface, a concrete class must specify that it implements the interface and must declare each method in the interface with the signature specified in the interface declaration.
- To specify that a class implements an interface, add the **implements** keyword and the name of the interface to the end of your class declaration's first line.
- Implementing an interface is like signing a contract with the compiler that states, "I will implement all the methods specified by the interface or I will declare my class **abstract**."
- Interfaces are Java's way to provide multiple inheritance.

Example: Using Interfaces

```
public interface Testable {  
    int K = 10;  
    void message();  
}
```

Interface declaration //same as class declaration

```
public class Test implements Testable{  
  
    @Override  
    public void message() {  
    }  
    public static void main(String [] args) {  
  
    }  
}
```

A class that implement the interface should override the methods of the interface
otherwise syntax error !

```
public abstract class Test2 implements Testable{  
}
```

or the class that implements the interface should be abstract class.

DEMO

Interfaces vs. Abstract Classes

	Variables	Constructors	Methods
Abstract class	No restrictions	Constructors are invoked by subclasses through constructor chaining. An abstract class cannot be instantiated	No restrictions
Interface	All variables must be public static final	No constructors. An interface cannot be instantiated	All methods must be public abstract instance method

Functional Interfaces

- As of Java SE 8, any interface containing only one *abstract* method is known as a **functional interface**.
- For example:
 - ***ActionListener*** —You'll implement this interface to define a method that's called when the user clicks a button.
 - ***Comparator*** —You'll implement this interface to define a method that can compare two objects of a given type to determine whether the first object is less than, equal to or greater than the second.
 - ***Runnable*** —You'll implement this interface to define a task that may be run in parallel with other parts of your program.